Lab 3 — Locating Databricks in the Azure Portal

Description

A guided tour of Azure Databricks as it appears in the Azure portal. You will find the workspace resource, open the managed resource group that Azure creates alongside it, and review the settings that the Azure platform — rather than Databricks — controls. This lab is read-only; nothing is created or changed.

Learning Objectives

- Locate the Azure Databricks workspace resource and identify its key properties.
- Explain what the managed resource group contains and why it is locked.
- Describe what the workspace storage account holds.
- Distinguish Azure RBAC on the workspace resource from permissions inside the workspace.

Step by Step Guide

1. Find the workspace resource. In the Azure portal, search for Azure Databricks or open the resource group holding your workspace, then select the workspace resource.
2. Review the Overview blade. Note the subscription, resource group, region, pricing tier and workspace URL. The Launch Workspace button opens the same workspace UI you used in Lab 1.
3. Open the managed resource group. On the Overview blade, follow the Managed Resource Group link. Note the name pattern — databricks-rg-<workspace>-<hash> — and that you did not create this group; Azure created it when the workspace was deployed.
4. List what it contains. Identify the workspace storage account. If a cluster is running, you will also see virtual machines, disks and network interfaces. A workspace using a Databricks-managed VNet will additionally show a virtual network, network security group and public IP.
5. Try to open the storage account. Select the storage account and attempt to browse its containers or access keys. Access is refused by a deny assignment that Azure Databricks creates — it cannot be overridden, even by a subscription Owner.
6. Note what the storage account holds. It contains the DBFS root and workspace system data such as job output, Databricks SQL results, notebook revisions and system settings. In some configurations it also holds a Unity Catalog workspace catalog. It does not hold the organisation's data, which lives in ADLS Gen2 outside this group.
7. Return to the workspace resource and open Networking. Review the network configuration, including whether the workspace is VNet-injected and whether public network access is permitted.
8. Open Access control (IAM). Review who holds Owner, Contributor or Reader on the workspace resource. This is Azure RBAC, and it is separate from the entitlements and permissions applied inside the workspace.

9. Open Diagnostic settings. Under Monitoring, check whether diagnostic log delivery is configured, and if so which categories are sent and to which destination.
10. Review Tags. Note the tags applied to the workspace. Tags set at workspace level propagate to the resources inside the managed resource group, which matters for cost attribution.
11. Note the deletion behaviour. Deleting the workspace resource also deletes the managed resource group and everything inside it. Do not delete anything in this lab.

Outcome

You can locate an Azure Databricks workspace in the Azure portal, explain the division between the resources you manage and the managed resource group that Databricks controls, and identify where the Azure platform governs networking, access and diagnostics for the workspace.